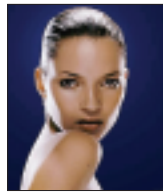


95 Ninja: Gaiden II
Die and Try Again



96 The Star Holds All
The Answers



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Lead Feature

Save The Bits, Save The World

How do Indians spend time online? Is any of it really constructive?

Agent 001

You see them everywhere. These horrid numbers and graphs that claim to say something, but always in gibberish or double-Dutch. From Google's Zeitgeist to your company's finance department, and your personal Web site's visitor data to numbers thrown at you in advertising-statistics, they say, never lie. Take, for example, the fact (so says The World Bank) that on average every woman in India gives birth to 2.9 children in their lifetime. What does 0.9 of a baby look like anyway? Is that code for short people, or a baby that's missing a toe? Anyway, jokes apart, we're talking about statistics here because we're looking at all of us Indian Internet users out there. What's the most popular browser? Which sites do we prefer to visit? What does India do online? If you have such questions, we're here to give you some answers, and a little bit of insight.

When it comes to the Internet, it's hard to ignore what Alexa.com has to say. Although the list changes often, depending on what's hot at the moment, we're taking a snapshot at the end of June to try and figure out what we're doing online as a country.

The Front Runners

The top three sites for Indians are Google.co.in, Yahoo.com and Google.com-weird because Google figures twice in the top three. Orkut India comes in a close fourth, and solidifies its position as India's most popular social networking site. YouTube is fifth, and here we begin to wonder. The average Net access speeds that Indians get certainly doesn't justify a bandwidth heavy site like YouTube being in the top five. Of course, thanks to the Mahatma and Munna Bhai,

maybe we're just doing some Gandhi-giri with our miserly Internet service providers and being more patient while pages load. Although, whether we need to start our own version of Satyagraha to get more bandwidth without limits is another discussion altogether.

Moving on, we find Blogger at 7, which means we Indians are an expressive bunch. Rapidshare rears its ugly head at 8, making all of us here at Digit go "Ah! There it is!" Apparently, all our anti-piracy articles haven't really had too much of an effect on the masses. And no, we don't believe you're actually using RapidShare's services to upload and download "legal stuff". Wikipedia at 10 is something we expected to see when we have Google at 1 and 3, since most of the information seekers that Google-up stuff, usually end up at Wikipedia. Orkut.com at 12, just ahead of Facebook just concretizes the fact that we love Google products.

After Dark

After rank 15, we start getting into the darker alleyways of the Indian mind. So far we've been seeing what most of us Indians do when working-with the exception of some social networking and YouTube-ing. Once the sun sets, we Indians cease to be G Rated, and end up scratching that itch. Coming in at 17 is a site that's notorious for adult-oriented and quite illegal content-XBoard.us. Between the next such site, at 18 and 19, come IMDB and CricInfo, which reinforces the fact that we Indians love our movies and cricket. Then at 20, comes Debonairblog.com, which is another adult site that specializes in MMS-scandals—need we say more? Adult FriendFinder—are there any "real" Indian profiles on it?—finds itself at 24,



An example of a typical post on DebonairBlog, where innocent women are exploited while going about regular life, yet the site stays afloat!